Zeh, Clauser, and the Fundamental Fysiks Group weren't the only ones facing professional consequences for investigating the foundations of quantum physics. Nearly every physicist of the time learned to avoid such questions as part of their training. But it was rarely an explicit part of their training—there was no concerted, deliberate effort to keep young physicists away from research on the foundations of quantum physics. There were other factors at work that merely had the side effect of keeping such research outside of the mainstream of professional physics. These historical factors are the same ones we've seen throughout this book. There was the lack of interest in foundational questions that came out of the postwar scientific funding model, which rewarded research with clear and concrete results in particular areas of physics. There was the ascendancy of American physics, which always had a more pragmatic bent than its European counterpart had. Philosophy played a role: positivism provided a variety of convenient ways to dismiss concerns about the Copenhagen interpretation. And the association of hidden-variables theories with communism (especially after Bohm), the overwhelming quantity of military funding in physics, and the still-fresh memories of the McCarthy era created a toxic brew: anyone flirting with hidden-variables theories opened themselves up to suspicion about their political convictions, a suspicion that could threaten the sources of funding that kept the lights on at nearly every physics department in the United States.

Young physicists were also discouraged from looking into the foundations of quantum physics precisely because the theory was so successful. With so many other fruitful avenues of research available, why bother with something as stubborn and abstract as quantum foundations, especially when Einstein himself hadn't been able to make sense of it? "As part of the 'common wisdom' taught in typical undergraduate and graduate curricula, students were told simply that Bohr was right and Einstein was wrong. That was the end of the story, and the end of the discussion," Clauser recalled. "Any student who questioned the theory's foundations, or, God forbid, considered studying the associated problems as a legitimate pursuit in physics was sternly advised that he would ruin his career by doing so." And the astonishing success of quantum physics in the laboratory, and the sheer power of its theoretical apparatus in explaining an